“Taking medication means I'm not really myself.”

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Where it often comes from

Some medicines change mood, energy, or thinking. Some people feel flattened or foggy, and others worry that treatment changes their personality or covers their “real” feelings. Fear of losing oneself makes people stop treatment on their own.

What Scripture teaches

God knows who you are: “O LORD, You have searched me and known me” (Psalm 139:1). Your identity is not a chemical state. It is rooted in being made by God and belonging to Him. Paul says, “Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day.” Treatment that helps your brain or body function better can free the real you, not erase you. If you feel different in a worrying way, tell your doctor. Do not stop on your own.

> *“O LORD, You have searched me and known me”* (Psalm 139:1).

Also see

> “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:13–14).

> “Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day” (2 Corinthians 4:16).

> “Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: ‘Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!’” (Isaiah 43:1).

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

Common self-statements

- I am not me on this medicine.
- It is changing who I am.
- My real self is gone.
- I feel numb.
- I am fake.
- I would rather feel pain than lose myself.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either fully myself or altered.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will lose my identity.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding that I am not myself.
- Labeling: Calling myself fake.

Challenging questions

- What exactly feels different, and when did it start?
- Was I more myself before, or was I in pain or fog?
- What do family and friends notice?

- What do I want my doctor to know?
- What helps me feel like me?
- What does it mean that God knows my true self?

Truth summary

> God knows me completely, and my identity does not rest on how I feel at the moment. If treatment is dulling me, my doctor can adjust it. I can seek the real me with care and honesty.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Therapy
- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, All Knowing
- Wisdom
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Taking medication means I'm not really myself"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Taking medication means I'm not really myself." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly feels different, and when did it start?
- ☐ Was I more myself before, or was I in pain or fog?
- ☐ What do family and friends notice?
- ☐ What do I want my doctor to know?
- ☐ What helps me feel like me?
- ☐ What does it mean that God knows my true self?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God knows me.
- ☐ My identity is in Him.
- ☐ My inner self is being renewed.
- ☐ I can tell my doctor what I feel.
- ☐ Adjustments are possible.
- ☐ I am still me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 139:1
  "O LORD, You have searched me and known me."
- ☐ Psalm 139:13–14
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Still me: Each week, note one thing that felt like you.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 139:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God knows me, and my identity rests in Him.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Therapy" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Track how you feel. Note mood, energy, and clarity.
- ☐ Tell your doctor. Report side effects or changes honestly.
- ☐ Ask a trusted person. Ask how they see you.
- ☐ Do not stop abruptly. Make changes only with your doctor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Taking medication means I'm not really myself": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still me
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Taking medication means I'm not really myself.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know the real me. Guide my doctors, give me honesty, and help me live as Your child, whatever my treatment. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.